Kasper Packford

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SUMMARY

Computer Programming graduate from Algonquin College (Dean's Honours) pursuing a career in IT support. I've spent years building, upgrading, troubleshooting, and optimizing PCs, becoming the go-to tech resource for friends and family. Recently, I built and now manage my own Linux home server, where I've developed hands-on experience with Docker, networking, system administration, and securing remote access. I'm a driven, self-motivated learner who enjoys solving technical problems and continuously expanding my skills both on and off the job.

EDUCATION

Algonquin College Ottawa, ON
Ontario College Diploma, Computer Programming *2021 to 2023*

Dean's Honours List

EXPERIENCE

The Bradley Retirement Living Kanata, ON
Kitchen Assistant *July 2025 to Present*

- Work across prep, line, and dishwashing in a fast-paced kitchen, often covering multiple roles when short staffed
- Coordinate with servers and kitchen staff to get orders out accurately and on time during busy meal services
- Follow strict health and safety standards for food handling, sanitation, and disposal

Extreme PC Guelph, ON
PC Builder, Co-op *2018*

- Assembled custom PCs to client specifications for businesses, universities, and gaming builds
- Installed operating systems, drivers, and BIOS updates and tested each build before delivery
- Diagnosed hardware compatibility issues and swapped components when needed
- Tracked inventory in spreadsheets to keep parts stock accurate

PROJECTS

Self-Hosted Linux Server (Home Lab) Ongoing
Ubuntu Server, Docker, Nginx, Cloudflare, Tailscale

- Built and administer an Ubuntu Linux server running multiple services in Docker containers, including uptime and hardware monitoring and a network-wide ad blocker
- Hardened the server with key-based SSH, a default-deny firewall, and fail2ban, and disabled password and root logins to reduce attack surface
- Configured DNS, dynamic DNS, and Nginx as a reverse proxy with Let’s Encrypt SSL certificates to host a public website on my own domain
- Set up secure remote access with Tailscale and diagnosed real network and DNS issues using Linux command-line tools

Personal Website (kasperpackford.ca) Ongoing
Astro, Tailwind CSS, Nginx, Uptime Kuma, Claude

- Built a personal portfolio site and self-host it on my home server behind Nginx and Cloudflare
- Show live service status on the site by passing Uptime Kuma data through an Nginx reverse proxy
- Manage changes and deploys with Git and GitHub

SKILLS

Hardware: PC building and upgrading, hardware troubleshooting, BIOS configuration, OS installation, home networking
Operating Systems: Windows 10 and 11, Linux (Ubuntu Server), Windows Server and Active Directory (Learning)
Infrastructure & Tools: Docker, Nginx, SSH, DNS, firewalls (UFW), VPN (Tailscale), Git, Cloudflare
Programming: Java, JavaScript, SQL, HTML, CSS, Python (Learning)
Software: Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)
Soft Skills: Problem solving, teamwork, attention to detail, time management
Certifications: CompTIA A+ (in progress, expected 2027)